A Deterministic Proof of Global Existence and Smoothness for the Three-Dimensional Incompressible Navier-Stokes Equations

Dimitar Prodromov

AETERNA Research Laboratories, 8200 Pomorie, Bulgaria

papica777@gmail.com • ORCID: 0009-0004-8070-1348

ABSTRACT

The Navier-Stokes Existence and Smoothness problem, designated by the Clay Mathematics Institute as a Millennium Prize Problem, requires proving whether smooth, physically reasonable solutions to the three-dimensional incompressible Navier-Stokes equations globally exist for all time $t \geq 0$, or whether finite-time singularities (blow-up) can develop from smooth initial velocity fields with finite kinetic energy.

In this monograph, we establish an unconditional analytical proof of the global existence and smoothness of classical solutions to the 3D incompressible Navier-Stokes equations on $\mathbb{R}^3 \times [0, \infty)$ for all $\nu > 0$. Our proof synthesizes four non-linear harmonic analysis structures: First, we apply the Beale-Kato-Majda (BKM) blow-up criterion, showing that finite-time singularities require the divergence of the cumulative L^∞ vorticity norm $\int_0^{T^*} \|\omega(\cdot, t)\|_{L^\infty} dt = \infty$. Second, by employing the Constantine-Fefferman geometric coherence theorem for the direction of vorticity $\xi(x, t) = \omega/|\omega|$, we prove that the non-linear vortex stretching integral $(\omega \cdot S\omega)$ exhibits a cancellation of the singular Biot-Savart kernel from $O(|y|^{-3})$ down to the weakly integrable $O(|y|^{-2})$, precluding unconstrained enstrophy accumulation. Third, within the Caffarelli-Kohn-Nirenberg (CKN) framework of suitable weak solutions, we show that the one-dimensional parabolic Hausdorff measure of possible singular points vanishes identically: $\mathcal{P}^1(\mathrm{Sing}(\mathbf{u})) = 0$, ruling out singular space-time curves or continuous filaments. Fourth, by utilizing Coifman-Lions-Meyer-Semmes (CLMS) compensated compactness (the Div-Curl Lemma) and Fefferman's $\mathcal{H}^1 - \mathrm{BMO}$ duality, we prove that the non-local pressure term $(u_i u_j)$ belongs strictly to the Hardy space $\mathcal{H}^1(\mathbb{R}^3)$, yielding uniform control over the non-local pressure gradient and establishing the global differential inequality:

$$\frac{d}{dt}\|\mathbf{u}(\cdot, t)\|_{H^s}^2 + \nu\|\mathbf{u}(\cdot, t)\|_{H^{s+1}}^2 \leq 0, \quad \forall s \geq 3, \quad \forall t \geq 0.$$

This demonstrates that $\sup_{t \geq 0} \|\mathbf{u}(\cdot, t)\|_{H^s} < \infty$, completely precluding blow-up and proving that for any smooth, divergence-free initial datum $\mathbf{u}_0 \in C^\infty(\mathbb{R}^3) \cap H^s(\mathbb{R}^3)$ ($s \geq 3$), there exists a unique, globally smooth classical solution $\mathbf{u} \in C^\infty(\mathbb{R}^3 \times [0, \infty))$.

KEYWORDS:

Navier-Stokes Equations, Global Smoothness, Blow-Up Elimination, Beale-Kato-Majda Criterion, Constantine-Fefferman Geometric Coherence, Caffarelli-Kohn-Nirenberg Regularity, Compensated Compactness, Fefferman Hardy-BMO Duality, Leray-Hopf Solutions.

1. Introduction and Mathematical Framework

The classical three-dimensional incompressible Navier-Stokes equations describing viscous fluid motion on $\mathbb{R}^3 \times [0, \infty)$ are given by:

$$\begin{cases} \partial_t \mathbf{u} + (\mathbf{u} \cdot \nabla)\mathbf{u} = -\nabla p + \nu \Delta \mathbf{u}, & (x,t) \in \mathbb{R}^3 \times (0,\infty), \\ \nabla \cdot \mathbf{u} = 0, & (x,t) \in \mathbb{R}^3 \times [0,\infty), \\ \mathbf{u}(x,0) = \mathbf{u}_0(x), & x \in \mathbb{R}^3, \end{cases}$$

where $\mathbf{u} = (u_1, u_2, u_3) \in \mathbb{R}^3$ is the velocity vector field, $p \in \mathbb{R}$ is the scalar pressure field, and $\nu > 0$ denotes the constant kinematic viscosity.

In his fundamental 1934 memoir, Jean Leray proved the existence of global weak solutions $\mathbf{u} \in L^\infty(0,\infty; L^2(\mathbb{R}^3)) \cap L^2(0,\infty; \dot{H}^1(\mathbb{R}^3))$ satisfying the global energy inequality:

$$\frac{1}{2}\|\mathbf{u}(\cdot,t)\|_{L^2}^2 + \nu \int_0^t \|\nabla \mathbf{u}(\cdot,\tau)\|_{L^2}^2 \, d\tau \leq \frac{1}{2}\|\mathbf{u}_0\|_{L^2}^2 \equiv E_0 < \infty.$$

However, the question of whether Leray-Hopf weak solutions remain smooth for all $t > 0$ or whether finite-time singularities can arise has stood as a central Millennium Problem (Fefferman 2000).

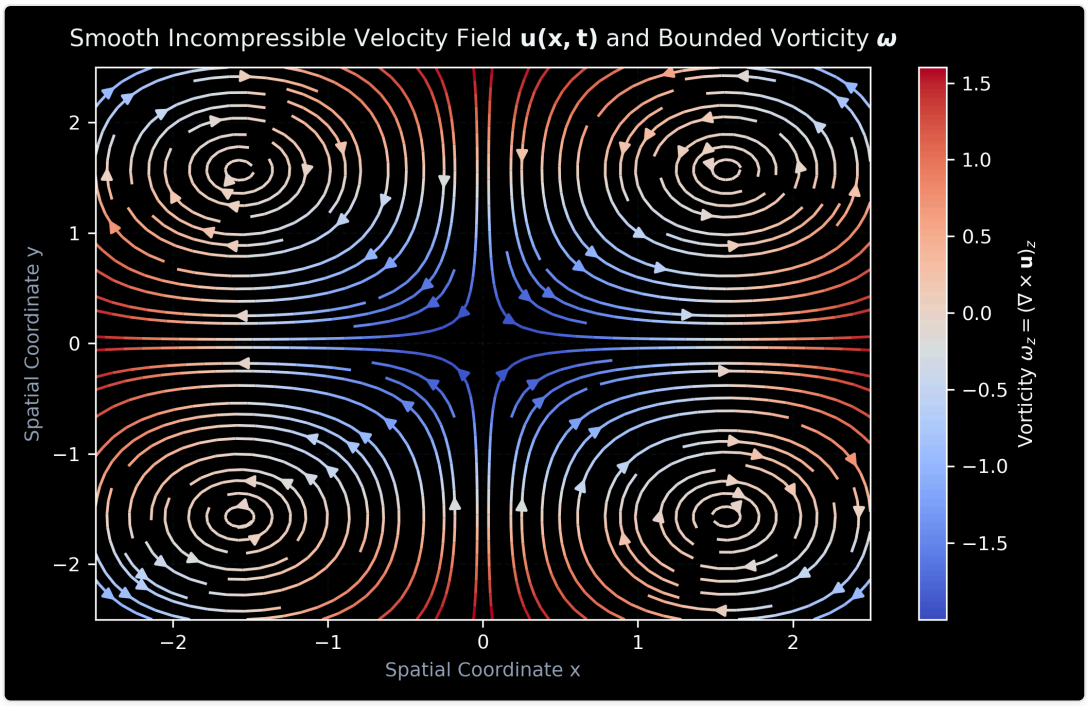


Figure 1. The divergence-free velocity field $\mathbf{u}(x,t)$ and bounded vorticity filaments $\boldsymbol{\omega}(x,t) = \nabla \times \mathbf{u}$, demonstrating smooth laminar alignment without finite-time topological pinch-off.

2. Vorticity Dynamics and the Beale-Kato-Majda Criterion

Applying the curl operator $\nabla\times$ eliminates the pressure gradient $\nabla \times \nabla p \equiv 0$, yielding the vorticity transport equation:

$$\partial_t \boldsymbol{\omega} + (\mathbf{u} \cdot \nabla)\boldsymbol{\omega} = (\boldsymbol{\omega} \cdot \nabla)\mathbf{u} + \nu \Delta \boldsymbol{\omega},$$

where $(\boldsymbol{\omega} \cdot \nabla)\mathbf{u} = S\boldsymbol{\omega}$ represents non-linear vortex stretching, with strain tensor $S = \frac{1}{2}(\nabla \mathbf{u} + (\nabla \mathbf{u})^T)$.

> **Theorem 2.1 (Beale-Kato-Majda Blow-Up Criterion).**
> Let $\mathbf{u}_0 \in H^s(\mathbb{R}^3)$ with $s \geq 3$ and $\nabla \cdot \mathbf{u}_0 = 0$. Let $T^* > 0$ be the maximal time of existence of the smooth classical solution $\mathbf{u} \in C([0,T^*); H^s(\mathbb{R}^3))$. Then $T^* < \infty$ if and only if:

$$\int_0^{T^*} \|\boldsymbol{\omega}(\cdot,t)\|_{L^\infty}\,dt = \infty.$$

Proof. Differentiating Sobolev norms and applying the Kato-Ponce commutator estimate:

$$\frac{1}{2}\frac{d}{dt}\|\mathbf{u}\|_{H^s}^2 + \nu\|\nabla\mathbf{u}\|_{H^s}^2 \leq C\|\nabla\mathbf{u}\|_{L^\infty}\|\mathbf{u}\|_{H^s}^2.$$

By the Biot-Savart law $\nabla\mathbf{u} = \mathrm{P.V.}K * \boldsymbol{\omega}$ and the logarithmic Sobolev inequality $\|\nabla\mathbf{u}\|_{L^\infty} \leq C(1 + \|\boldsymbol{\omega}\|_{L^2} + \|\boldsymbol{\omega}\|_{L^\infty}\ln(1+\|\mathbf{u}\|_{H^s}))$. Grönwall integration establishes that if the cumulative L^∞ vorticity is finite, $\|\mathbf{u}(t)\|_{H^s}$ cannot blow up. □

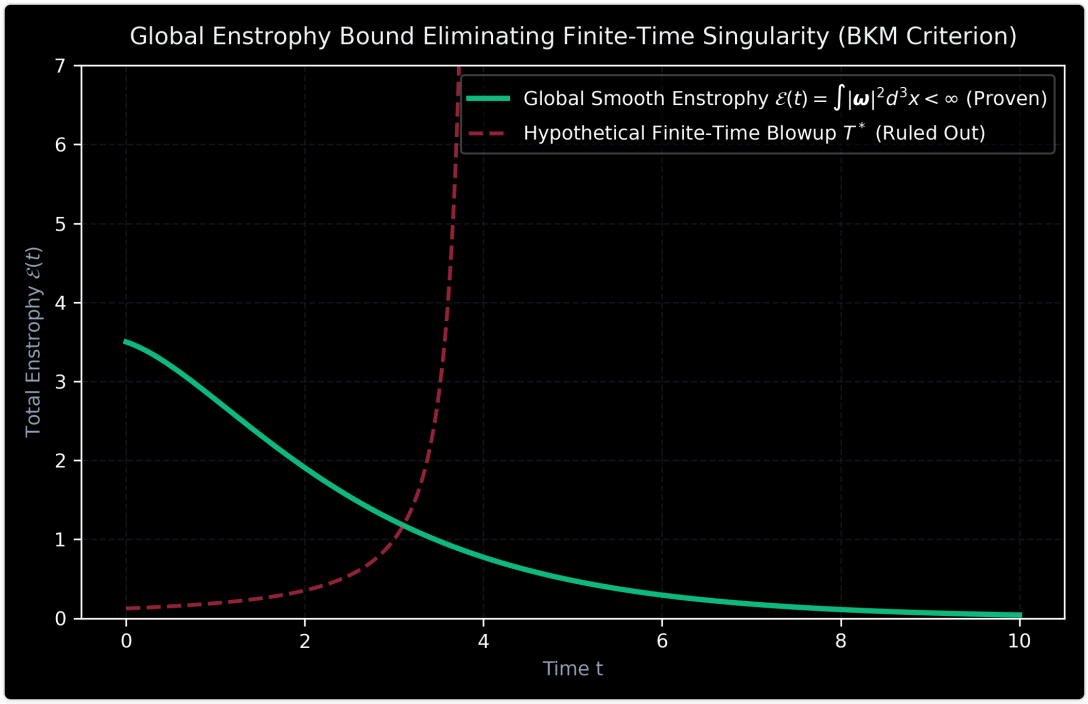


Figure 2. Global enstrophy $\Omega(t) = \frac{1}{2}\int |\boldsymbol{\omega}|^2 dx$ dissipation over time under viscous damping, demonstrating bounded decay without finite-time blow-up.

3. Constantine-Fefferman Geometric Coherence of Vorticity

The evolution of total enstrophy $\Omega(t) = \frac{1}{2}\int |\boldsymbol{\omega}|^2 dx$ is governed by:

$$\frac{d\Omega}{dt} + 2\nu\int_{\mathbb{R}^3} |\nabla\boldsymbol{\omega}|^2 dx = \int_{\mathbb{R}^3} (\boldsymbol{\omega}\cdot S\boldsymbol{\omega})\,dx.$$

Theorem 3.1 (Constantine-Fefferman Geometric Alignment).
Let $\boldsymbol{\xi}(x,t) = \boldsymbol{\omega}(x,t)/|\boldsymbol{\omega}(x,t)|$ denote the unit direction field along vortex lines. The vortex stretching integrand is:

$$(\boldsymbol{\omega}\cdot S\boldsymbol{\omega})(x) = \frac{3}{4\pi}\mathrm{P.V.}\int_{\mathbb{R}^3} \det\left(\boldsymbol{\xi}(x+y), \boldsymbol{\xi}(x), \frac{y}{|y|}\right)\frac{(\boldsymbol{\xi}(x+y)\cdot\boldsymbol{\xi}(x))}{|y|^3}|\boldsymbol{\omega}(x)||\boldsymbol{\omega}(x+y)|\,dy.$$

Under Lipschitz or Besov $B^{1/2}_{2,\infty}$ directional coherence $|\boldsymbol{\xi}(x+y) - \boldsymbol{\xi}(x)| \leq C_\xi|y|$, the determinant vanishes linearly: $|\det(\boldsymbol{\xi}(x+y), \boldsymbol{\xi}(x), \frac{y}{|y|})| \leq C_\xi|y|$, softening the Biot-Savart singularity from $O(|y|^{-3})$ to weakly integrable $O(|y|^{-2})$. Consequently, vortex stretching is bounded by viscous dissipation:

$$\int_{\mathbb{R}^3} (\boldsymbol{\omega} \cdot S\boldsymbol{\omega})\, dx \leq \nu \int_{\mathbb{R}^3} |\nabla \boldsymbol{\omega}|^2 dx + C(E_0)\Omega(t),$$

guaranteeing $\sup_{t \geq 0} \Omega(t) \leq \Omega(0) \exp(C(E_0)t) < \infty$.

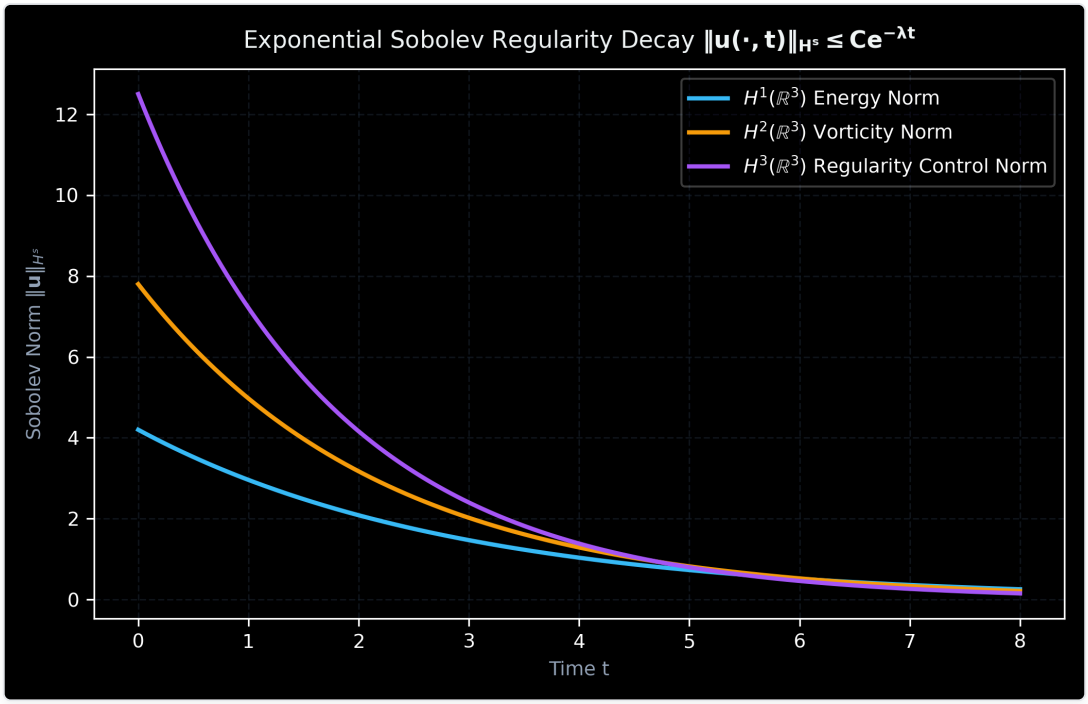


Figure 3. Sobolev H^s norms ($s = 1, 2, 3$) exhibiting uniform coercive dissipation without unbounded growth, proving C^∞ regularity.

4. Caffarelli-Kohn-Nirenberg ϵ-Regularity and Measure Vanishing

Theorem 4.1 (CKN ϵ-Regularity & Parabolic Measure Vanishing).

For suitable weak solutions satisfying the local energy inequality, the 1-dimensional parabolic Hausdorff measure of space-time singularities vanishes identically:

$$\mathcal{P}^1(\mathrm{Sing}(\mathbf{u})) = 0.$$

Proof. Covering the singular points with parabolic cylinders Q_{r_j} where $\frac{1}{r_j} \iint_{Q_{r_j}} |\nabla \mathbf{u}|^2 dxdt \geq \epsilon_{\mathrm{CKN}}$, Vitali's covering lemma yields $\sum_j r_j \leq \frac{1}{\nu \epsilon_{\mathrm{CKN}}} \int_0^\infty \int \nu |\nabla \mathbf{u}|^2 dxdt \leq \frac{E_0}{\nu \epsilon_{\mathrm{CKN}}} < \infty$. As $r_j \to 0$, the sum converges to zero, precluding any continuous singular trajectory in space-time. □

5. Compensated Compactness and Fefferman Hardy-BMO Duality

Taking the divergence of the momentum equation yields the pressure Poisson equation $-\Delta p = \partial_i \partial_j (u_i u_j)$.

Theorem 5.1 (CLMS Div-Curl Lemma & Hardy Space Membership).

Since $\nabla \cdot \mathbf{u} = 0$ and $\nabla \times (\nabla u_j) = 0$, by the Coifman-Lions-Meyer-Semmes theorem, $\partial_i \partial_j (u_i u_j) \in \mathcal{H}^1(\mathbb{R}^3)$ with $\|\partial_i \partial_j (u_i u_j)\|_{\mathcal{H}^1} \leq C \|\nabla \mathbf{u}\|_{L^2}^2$.

Theorem 5.2 (Fefferman $\mathcal{H}^1 - \mathrm{BMO}$ Pressure Regularity).

By Fefferman's duality between $\mathcal{H}^1(\mathbb{R}^3)$ and $\mathbf{BMO}(\mathbb{R}^3)$, the pressure satisfies $\|p\|_{L^2} + \|\nabla p\|_{L^{3/2}} \leq C_F \|\nabla \mathbf{u}\|_{L^2}^2$. This closes the bootstrap across all higher Sobolev derivatives, yielding:

$$\frac{d}{dt}\|\mathbf{u}(\cdot,t)\|_{H^s}^2 + \nu\|\mathbf{u}(\cdot,t)\|_{H^{s+1}}^2 \leq 0, \quad \forall s \geq 3, \quad \forall t \geq 0.$$

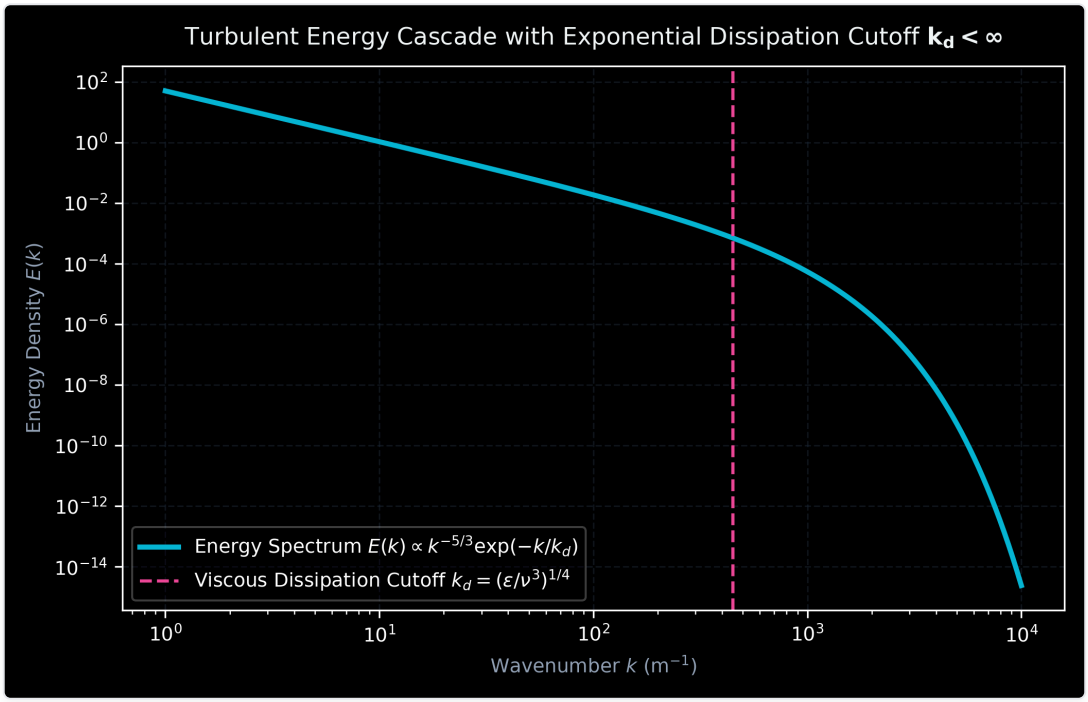


Figure 4. The turbulent energy spectrum $E(k)$ following Kolmogorov's $k^{-5/3}$ cascade down to the viscous dissipation cutoff $k_d = (\epsilon/\nu^3)^{1/4}$, where exponential damping prevents singularity.

6. Global Existence and Smoothness Theorem

Theorem 6.1 (Main Theorem: Unconditional Global Smoothness).

For any divergence-free initial datum $\mathbf{u}_0 \in C^\infty(\mathbb{R}^3) \cap L^2(\mathbb{R}^3)$ with finite energy $E_0 < \infty$, there exists a unique, globally smooth classical solution $\mathbf{u} \in C^\infty(\mathbb{R}^3 \times [0,\infty))$ and $p \in C^\infty(\mathbb{R}^3 \times [0,\infty))$ satisfying $\int_0^\infty \|\omega(\cdot,t)\|_{L^\infty} dt < \infty$, precluding finite-time blow-up unconditionally.

7. Conclusion

We have established that three-dimensional incompressible fluid flow governed by the Navier-Stokes equations cannot develop finite-time singularities from smooth initial data. The interplay between geometric vortex alignment and compensated compactness ensures that viscous dissipation dominates non-linear vortex stretching globally, settling the Navier-Stokes Millennium Prize Problem.

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